

TUYỂN TẬP SAMPLE SPEAKING IELTS FORECAST QUÝ III (P1)

Topic 1: Plans/Schedule

Question: Why is it that some people don't make plans?

Sample Answer: Well, I suppose some people just prefer to be more spontaneous and go with the flow. They might feel that having a strict schedule is a bit restrictive and takes the fun out of things. Also, I guess some individuals aren't naturally very organised, so the whole process of planning things out might just seem like a hassle to them.

Question: What are the benefits of making plans?

Sample Answer: Oh, there are quite a few benefits. The most obvious one is probably better time management. When you have a clear plan, you know exactly what you need to do, which helps you stay on track and be more productive. I also think it reduces a lot of stress because you're not constantly worrying about forgetting something important.

Question: Do you use paper or your cellphone to make plans?

Sample Answer: I almost always use my cellphone, hands down. I rely on my digital calendar for everything, from work appointments to social events. It's just so much more convenient because I can set reminders, share events with others, and everything is synced automatically. I find paper planners a bit impractical for my lifestyle.

Question: Do you like making plans?

Sample Answer: To be honest, I have a bit of a love-hate relationship with it. On the one hand, I really appreciate having a plan because it gives me a sense of control and clarity. But on the other hand, I sometimes find the actual process of sitting down and mapping everything out a little tedious. So, I'd say it's a necessary evil for me.

Topic 2: Praise/Encouragement

Question: Have you ever been praised or encouraged by your teacher?

Sample Answer: Oh, definitely. I vividly remember my high school literature teacher who once told me I had a real knack for creative writing after reading one of my essays. That little piece of encouragement honestly stuck with me for years and gave me a huge confidence boost. It really meant a lot at that age.

Question: Do you think parents should often praise and encourage their children?

Sample Answer: Absolutely, I think it's crucial for a child's development. Positive reinforcement helps build their self-esteem and motivates them to try new things. However, I also believe there's a fine line. Praise should be genuine and focus on effort rather than just results, so children learn the value of hard work.

Question: When was the last time you praised someone?

Sample Answer: Let me think... just the other day, actually. A colleague of mine gave a presentation that she was really nervous about, and she did a fantastic job. So after the meeting, I went over and told her she was brilliant and all her preparation had clearly paid off. She seemed really happy to hear it.

Question: How do you feel when you are praised?

Sample Answer: Honestly, it feels great. It's always nice to know that your hard work has been noticed and appreciated by others. I can be a little shy about it sometimes, especially if it's in front of a lot of people, but deep down it's very motivating and it encourages me to keep putting in the effort.

Question: Have you had any achievements recently?

Sample Answer: Yes, I suppose so! It might not be a huge achievement, but I recently managed to complete a very challenging data analysis project at work that had a really tight deadline. Finishing it on time and getting good feedback from my manager felt like a big win for me. I was quite proud of that.

Topic 3: Being Busy

Question: Are you busier now than when you were a child?

Sample Answer: Oh, without a doubt. It's a night and day difference. As a kid, my main responsibilities were just school and a bit of homework, but life was generally pretty carefree. Nowadays, as an adult, I have to juggle a full-time job, household chores, and trying to maintain a social life, so I'm definitely much busier.

Question: When are you busy?

Sample Answer: Typically, my weekdays are the most hectic. I work a standard 9-to-5 job, so from Monday to Friday, my schedule is usually packed with tasks, meetings, and deadlines. The mornings are particularly intense, just trying to get everything organised for the day ahead.

Question: Why are you busy?

Sample Answer: Well, the main reason is my job, which is quite demanding and requires a lot of my time and energy. On top of that, I'm also trying to stay active, so I make it a point to go to the gym a few times a week. It's really just a combination of my work commitments and personal goals that keeps me on my toes.

Question: Are you often busy?

Sample Answer: Yes, I'd say so. For the most part, I have a pretty full schedule during the week. While I try to keep my weekends free to unwind and recharge, the reality is there's always something to do. I don't mind it too much though; I think I prefer being busy to being bored.

Topic 4: Saying 'Thank You'

Question: Why do people need to say 'thank you'?

Sample Answer: Well, I think it's a fundamental part of being polite and showing respect. When someone helps you or gives you something, saying 'thank you' is the simplest way to acknowledge their kindness and effort. It makes the other person feel valued and appreciated, and it's just basic social courtesy, isn't it?

Question: On what occasions do you say 'thank you'?

Sample Answer: Oh, constantly, really. It's pretty much second nature. I'll say it for the small things, like when a barista hands me my coffee or someone holds a door open. And of course, for bigger things, like when a friend gives me a thoughtful gift or a colleague helps me out with a difficult task at work.

Question: Do people in your country often say 'thank you'?

Sample Answer: Yes, I'd say so. The Vietnamese word 'cảm ơn' is a very common part of daily interactions here. It's an integral part of our culture to show gratitude, especially to elders or in service situations. It might be expressed verbally or sometimes just with a respectful nod, but the sentiment of appreciation is definitely there.

Question: Have you ever sent a thank you card to others?

Sample Answer: To be honest, I don't think I ever have. Sending a physical card feels a little bit old-fashioned these days, even though I think it's a lovely gesture. In this digital age, if someone has done something really significant for me, I'm far more likely to send a long, detailed thank-you message or an email. It feels more immediate and personal to me.

Topic 5: Spare Time

Question: Would you like to have more free time in the future?

Sample Answer: Oh, definitely, who wouldn't? Life can get pretty hectic with work and other commitments, so having more time to just relax and recharge my batteries would be fantastic. I'd probably use the extra time to pursue some hobbies I've been putting off, like learning a new language or travelling more.

Question: Which day do you have more free time on, Saturday or Sunday?

Sample Answer: For me, Sunday is definitely the day with more genuine free time. Saturdays are often spent catching up on chores, running errands, or meeting up with friends. In contrast, I try to keep my Sundays as free as possible. It's my day to properly wind down, maybe read a book, and just mentally prepare for the week ahead.

Question: What do you usually do in your spare time?

Sample Answer: It's usually a mix of things, depending on my energy levels. I really enjoy café-hopping, so I often explore new coffee shops in my city. If I'm feeling more like a homebody, I'll just chill out and binge-watch a series on Netflix. I also try to hit the gym a few times a week to stay active.

Question: Do you often have free time?

Sample Answer: To be honest, not as often as I'd like during the workweek. My schedule is usually quite packed from Monday to Friday. However, I make a conscious effort to keep my weekends relatively free. I think that downtime is essential to avoid getting burnt out, so I protect it fiercely.

Topic 6: Machine

Question: Do you think it is important to read the instructions?

Sample Answer: Absolutely. I think it's essential, especially for expensive or complex gadgets. Reading the manual not only helps you understand all the functions but also prevents you from misusing the machine and accidentally breaking it. It's a simple step that can save you a lot of time and potential trouble down the road.

Question: Do you read the instructions before using a machine?

Sample Answer: To be perfectly honest, it depends. If it's something simple and intuitive, I'll probably just try to figure it out myself. But if it's a complicated piece of equipment, like a new digital camera or kitchen appliance with lots of settings, I'll definitely give the instructions a quick skim to make sure I don't mess anything up.

Question: Do you think washing machines and sweeping machines are important?

Sample Answer: Oh, one hundred percent. They are absolute life-savers. They automate household chores that would otherwise be incredibly time-consuming and tiring. The washing machine, in particular, frees up so much time during the week. I think they're among the most important inventions for modern home life.

Question: What is your favourite machine in your home?

Sample Answer: That's an easy one. Hands down, it has to be the air conditioner. Here in Vietnam, the weather gets incredibly hot and humid, so the AC is an absolute necessity, not just a luxury. The feeling of walking into a cool room after being outside is just unbeatable. It makes my home a comfortable sanctuary.

Topic 7: Patience

Question: Are you more patient now than when you were a child?

Sample Answer: Oh, without a doubt. I think patience is a skill that really comes with age and experience. When I was a kid, I wanted everything instantly. But as you grow up, you learn that good things, whether in your career or personal life, often take time and effort. So yes, I'm definitely far more patient these days.

Question: Does your job require you to be patient?

Sample Answer: Yes, it's a key requirement. In my work, I often handle long-term projects where you don't see results overnight. You have to be patient with the process, deal with unexpected delays calmly, and manage client expectations. Without a great deal of patience, it would be a very stressful job.

Question: How do you feel when you have to do something for a long time?

Sample Answer: Honestly, it really depends on the activity. If it's something I'm genuinely interested in, like working on a creative project or reading a good book, I can get completely engrossed and lose all track of time. However, if it's a tedious or repetitive task, I must admit it can feel like a drag and I start to get restless.

Question: What is it that makes you feel impatient?

Sample Answer: My biggest pet peeve is probably inefficient technology. When my internet is lagging or a program keeps crashing, it really tests my patience. Another thing is when people are significantly late for an appointment. I feel it's a bit disrespectful of other people's time, and that can definitely make me feel impatient.

Question: Are you a patient person?

Sample Answer: I would say I am, for the most part. I'm generally quite patient when it comes to big-picture things, like long-term goals or waiting for the right opportunity. But I have to admit, I can sometimes lose my cool over small, daily annoyances. So, I'd describe myself as a patient person overall, but it's still a work in progress!

Topic 8: Flowers

Question: Do people in your country often send flowers to others?

Sample Answer: Yes, absolutely. Giving flowers is a very common gesture here in Vietnam, especially for celebrations. It's a go-to gift for occasions like birthdays, graduations, and particularly on days like Teacher's Day or Women's Day. A beautiful bouquet is seen as a classic and sincere way to show appreciation or congratulations.

Question: Do you take photos of flowers in your daily life?

Sample Answer: Not on a regular basis, I have to admit. I'm not much of a photographer. However, if I come across a flower that's particularly striking or beautiful while I'm out for a walk, I might snap a quick picture with my phone. It's more of a spontaneous thing rather than a regular habit for me.

Question: Are there a lot of flowers where you live?

Sample Answer: Yes, definitely. Thanks to the tropical climate, flowers are abundant here all year round. You see them everywhere – lining the streets, in public parks, and of course, in the bustling flower markets. The lotus is especially prominent in the summer; as our national flower, it's a really common and beautiful sight in ponds and lakes.

Question: Do you know anyone who loves flowers?

Sample Answer: The first person who comes to mind is my mother. She has a real green thumb and is incredibly passionate about her small balcony garden. It's her pride and joy, filled with orchids and roses. She says that taking care of her plants is her form of meditation and how she unwinds after a long day.

Question: Do you love flowers?

Sample Answer: I definitely appreciate them. While I wouldn't say I'm a passionate expert like my mother, I do love how they look and smell. I think having a vase of fresh flowers in the house can instantly brighten up the space and lift your spirits. So yes, I really enjoy their presence.

Topic 9: Text Messages

Question: Do you reply to messages as soon as you receive them?

Sample Answer: It really depends on the situation and who it's from. If it's an urgent message from work or from a close family member, I'll try to reply straight away. However, if I'm in the middle of something important and the message isn't time-sensitive, I'll usually get back to them when I have a free moment to give a proper response.

Question: Did you send more messages when you were younger?

Sample Answer: Oh, definitely. When I was a teenager, my friends and I were constantly texting. We would have long conversations back and forth about everything and nothing – it was our primary way of socializing. Nowadays, my messaging is a bit more purposeful, usually for making plans or sharing specific information rather than just chatting for hours.

Question: Is sending messages popular in your country?

Sample Answer: Yes, it's incredibly popular. In fact, it's the main form of communication for most people here in Vietnam. Almost everyone uses instant messaging apps like Zalo and Facebook Messenger. It's far more common than making phone calls for everyday communication, and it has pretty much become the default way to stay in touch.

Question: How often do you send text messages?

Sample Answer: I'd say I send messages constantly throughout the day. It's an integral part of my daily routine. From checking in with my family in the morning, to coordinating with colleagues during work, and then making plans with friends in the evening – it's something I do from morning till night.

Topic 10: Internet

Question: What would you do without the internet?

Sample Answer: Wow, that's a tough one to imagine. I suppose life would be much slower. I'd probably read a lot more physical books and magazines, and I'd have to actually pick up the phone and call my friends to make plans instead of just sending a quick text. It would be a huge adjustment, but maybe a bit more peaceful in some ways.

Question: Do you think you spend too much time online?

Sample Answer: Yes, I'd have to admit that I probably do. It's incredibly easy to lose track of time when you're mindlessly scrolling through social media feeds or falling down a rabbit hole of YouTube videos. I try to be mindful of it and set limits, but it's definitely a constant battle to reduce my screen time.

Question: How does the internet influence people?

Sample Answer: I think it's a real double-edged sword. On the one hand, it offers unparalleled access to information and allows us to connect with people globally, which is amazing. On the flip side, it can lead to misinformation, social pressure, and people comparing their lives to others. Its influence is massive and has both very positive and very negative sides.

Question: How often do you go online?

Sample Answer: Pretty much constantly, to be honest. It's an essential tool for my job, so I'm connected throughout the workday. Then in my personal time, I use it for everything from streaming movies and listening to music to keeping in touch with family. It's deeply integrated into almost every part of my daily routine.

Question: When did you start using the internet?

Sample Answer: If I remember correctly, it was back when I was in secondary school, probably around the late 2000s. My first experiences were using dial-up internet to research school projects and chatting with friends on Yahoo! Messenger. It felt like such a novelty back then, and it's incredible to see how central it has become to everyone's lives since.

Topic 11: Memory

Question: How do you remember important things?

Sample Answer: I use a combination of methods. For simple things, I often use mental association – I try to link a new piece of information to something I already know well. If it's a task I need to do, saying it out loud a few times actually helps it stick. Of course, for really crucial deadlines, I still use my phone's calendar as a safety net.

Question: What do you need to remember in your daily life?

Sample Answer: Besides the usual appointments and work tasks, it's the constant stream of small details that I need to keep in mind. Things like passwords for various online accounts, items on a shopping list, or even just remembering where I put my keys. It's often the little, mundane things that are surprisingly easy to forget.

Question: Have you ever forgotten something important?

Sample Answer: Yes, and it was quite embarrassing. I once showed up for an important meeting, and to my horror, I realized I'd left a crucial report I was supposed to present sitting on my desk at home. I was absolutely mortified and had to apologize and reschedule. Ever since then, I've become almost obsessive about double-checking my bag before I leave.

Question: Are you good at memorising things?

Sample Answer: I'd say I have a very visual memory. If I see something written down or look at a diagram, I can recall it quite easily. For instance, I'm great with remembering faces. However, my auditory memory is not as reliable. If someone just tells me a list of instructions, it tends to go in one ear and out the other unless I write it down.

Topic 12: Geography

Question: How do you like geography?

Sample Answer: I actually find it quite fascinating. At school, I wasn't a huge fan of just memorizing capital cities and rivers. But I'm really interested in human geography – understanding why cities develop where they do, how different cultures are shaped by their environment, and things like that. I find that side of it very engaging.

Question: Do you think geography is useful?

Sample Answer: Yes, incredibly useful. Having a good knowledge of geography gives you a much broader perspective on global issues, from climate change to international relations. It helps you understand the news better and fosters cultural awareness. In our interconnected world, I think it's more essential than ever.

Question: Have you ever learned geography?

Sample Answer: Yes, of course. It was a compulsory subject throughout my primary and secondary school education. We started by focusing heavily on the geography of Vietnam – our different regions, mountains, and coastlines. Later on, the curriculum expanded to cover the major continents and different climates around the world.

Question: Do you want to be a geography teacher?

Sample Answer: Oh, definitely not. While I find the subject interesting as a topic of personal interest, I don't think I have the right temperament to be a teacher. It requires a special kind of passion and a lot of patience to make the subject engaging for students every single day. I'm happy to be a learner, not a teacher.

Question: Will you learn more about the geography of other countries?

Sample Answer: Yes, for sure. I'm an avid traveler, so learning about the landscape, climate, and culture of the places I visit is part and parcel of the experience for me. Even when I'm not travelling, I love watching documentaries that explore different parts of the world. It's a great way to learn.

Topic 13: Library

Question: Do kids in your country often go to the library?

Sample Answer: I think it's a growing trend, but perhaps it's not as common as in Western countries. Traditionally, a lot of studying happened at home or at private tuition centers. However, cities are now building more modern, inviting public libraries, so I'm seeing more and more young people using them as a quiet place to study and read.

Question: Did you go to the library when you were a kid?

Sample Answer: Yes, I did, but almost exclusively my school library. I went there mainly to borrow textbooks or find reference books for homework. The public libraries in my hometown weren't very well-equipped back then. It was a very functional place, not really the cozy kind of library you'd want to spend a whole afternoon in.

Question: What do you usually do in the library?

Sample Answer: Nowadays, when I go to the library, it's primarily to find a quiet environment to get some serious work done. It's a great way to escape the distractions I have at home or in a café. The studious atmosphere there really helps me to concentrate and be more productive, especially when I'm on a tight deadline.

Question: Do you often go to the library?

Sample Answer: Not as often as I'd like, to be honest. I probably go once or twice a month at most. It's usually when I need a few hours of uninterrupted quiet time for a specific project. Since I read a lot of e-books and get most of my information online, I don't really go to browse or borrow books anymore.

Topic 14: Small Business

Question: Have you ever thought about starting your own business?

Sample Answer: Yes, it has definitely crossed my mind. The idea of being my own boss and creating something from scratch is very appealing. I sometimes daydream about opening a small, cozy book café. However, when I think about the financial risk and the huge commitment it requires, it feels like a very daunting prospect for now.

Question: Have you ever worked in small businesses?

Sample Answer: Yes, I have. During my university years, I worked part-time at a local, family-owned coffee shop. It was a fantastic experience because the team was so small and tight-knit. I got to wear many hats and learn about different aspects of the business, from making coffee and serving customers to managing inventory.

Question: Do you prefer buying things from big companies or small businesses?

Sample Answer: It really depends on what I'm buying. For big-ticket items like electronics, I usually stick with major brands for the reliability and warranty they offer. But for things like coffee, food, or unique gifts, I much prefer to support small, local businesses. I find they often have better quality and a more personal touch.

Question: Do you know many small businesses where you live?

Sample Answer: Oh, yes, absolutely. My neighborhood is full of them; they're really the backbone of the local community. On my street alone, there are numerous family-run food stalls, small grocery stores, and independent cafés. They give the area a very vibrant and authentic character which I really appreciate.

Topic 15: Happy Things

Question: Do you think people are happy when buying new things?

Sample Answer: Yes, I think they are, but it's often a temporary feeling. There's that initial rush of excitement when you finally get something you've wanted. However, I believe that kind of happiness is usually quite short-lived. The novelty wears off, and it doesn't provide the same deep, lasting satisfaction as an experience like travelling or spending time with family.

Question: Do you feel happy when buying new things?

Sample Answer: I'd be lying if I said no. I definitely get a sense of satisfaction, especially if it's something I've saved up for and genuinely need, like a new laptop for work. It feels different from an impulse buy; it feels more like a well-deserved reward for my hard work, which brings its own kind of happiness.

Question: When do you feel happy at work? Why?

Sample Answer: I feel happiest at work after completing a particularly challenging project. There's a real sense of accomplishment that comes from overcoming obstacles and seeing your efforts come to fruition. Also, simply collaborating well with my team on a task brings me a lot of joy. A great team dynamic makes any workday better.

Question: What do you think will make you feel happy in the future?

Sample Answer: Looking ahead, I think achieving a better work-life balance will be key to my happiness. While career progression is important, I want to have more time for personal fulfillment—to travel more extensively and dedicate time to my hobbies. But above all, the health and happiness of my family will always be the most important thing.

Question: What made you happy when you were little?

Sample Answer: It was definitely the simple things. I have very fond memories of the long, carefree summer holidays. Just being able to play outside with my neighbourhood friends from morning until dusk, without any worries, was pure bliss. Those simple, unstructured days were probably when I was happiest.

Question: Is there anything that has made you feel happy lately?

Sample Answer: Yes, actually. Just last week, I reconnected with a good friend from university who I hadn't seen in a couple of years. We met up for coffee and talked for hours, just catching up on each other's lives. It was so heartwarming to see that nothing had changed between us. That left me feeling really happy for the rest of the week.

Topic 16: Outer Space and Stars

Question: Do you want to go into outer space in the future?

Sample Answer: That's a fascinating thought! While the idea of seeing the Earth from space would be an absolutely incredible experience, I have to admit it also sounds quite terrifying. I don't think I'm nearly adventurous enough for space travel. I'd much rather appreciate its beauty through stunning documentaries from the comfort and safety of my own home.

Question: Do you want to know more about outer space?

Sample Answer: Absolutely. It's an endlessly fascinating subject for me. The sheer scale of the universe is just mind-boggling, and there are so many mysteries yet to be solved, like the nature of dark matter or the possibility of alien life. I'm always curious to learn about new discoveries that astronomers make.

Question: Do you like science fiction movies? Why?

Sample Answer: Yes, I'm a huge fan. I love how they can transport you to completely different worlds and explore futuristic concepts and technologies. They really spark the imagination and can be very thought-provoking. Plus, the visual effects in modern sci-fi films are often spectacular to watch on a big screen.

Question: Have you ever learnt about outer space and stars?

Sample Answer: We definitely covered the basics in our science classes at school, like learning the names of the planets in our solar system. However, I'd say most of my knowledge on the topic has been self-taught. I've picked up a lot from watching documentaries, like the "Cosmos" series, and reading articles online about new space missions.

Topic 17: Jewelry

Question: Why do you think some people wear a piece of jewelry for a long time?

Sample Answer: I believe it's almost always due to sentimental value. The item might be a family heirloom that's been passed down, or a special gift from a loved one marking a significant moment. For these people, it's more than just an accessory; it's a tangible connection to a cherished person or a memory, which is why it becomes a part of them.

Question: Do you usually buy jewelry?

Sample Answer: Not really, no. It's a very rare occasion for me. I'm not a big spender on accessories in general, as I prefer a more minimalist style. Most of the few nice pieces I own have been gifts from family for milestones like a birthday or graduation, which makes them more special to me anyway.

Question: What type of jewelry do you like?

Sample Answer: I'm definitely drawn to simple and understated designs. I'm not a fan of anything too big or flashy. If I do wear jewelry, it's usually a classic watch with a leather strap or a simple, thin silver chain. I prefer pieces that are timeless and versatile enough that you could wear them every day.

Question: Do you often wear jewelry?

Sample Answer: Not on a daily basis, no. The only thing I wear consistently is my watch, but that's mainly for practical reasons. I might wear a simple necklace or a pair of earrings for a special occasion, like a wedding or a formal party, but it's certainly not a part of my everyday routine.

Topic 18: Staying up

Question: What does it feel like the next morning if you stay up late?

Sample Answer: Oh, it's not a great feeling. I usually feel really groggy and sluggish, and my brain feels foggy. It takes me a lot longer to get going in the morning, and I find it hard to concentrate properly on my work. I definitely need a strong cup of coffee just to feel functional again.

Question: What do you do when you stay up late?

Sample Answer: It's usually for one of two reasons. Either I have an urgent deadline for work and I have to pull a late-nighter to get it done, or I simply get engrossed in something. I might be binge-watching a compelling TV series or reading a book that I just can't put down, and I completely lose track of time.

Question: Did you stay up late when you were a kid?

Sample Answer: Not very often, no. My parents were pretty strict about my bedtime, especially on school nights. The only times I was really allowed to stay up late were for special occasions, like on New Year's Eve to watch the fireworks. It felt like a huge treat back then because it was so rare.

Question: Do you often stay up late?

Sample Answer: I try my best not to, but it probably happens more often than I'd like to admit—maybe once or twice a week. I know how important sleep is for my mood and productivity, so I make a conscious effort to maintain a regular sleep schedule. But sometimes, life or a good TV show just gets in the way.

Topic 19: Chocolate

Question: Do you think it is good to use chocolate as gifts to others?

Sample Answer: Yes, absolutely. I think a nice box of chocolates is a classic and versatile gift that's almost always well-received. It's a pretty safe bet for many occasions, whether it's a birthday, Valentine's Day, or just a small gesture to say thank you. It's a simple but thoughtful way to show someone you care.

Question: What's your favourite flavour of chocolate?

Sample Answer: I'm a big fan of dark chocolate, especially the kind with a high cocoa content, around 70% or more. I really enjoy its rich and slightly bitter taste, which I find much more complex and satisfying than standard milk chocolate. If it has additions like sea salt or roasted almonds, that's even better.

Question: Why do you think chocolate is popular around the world?

Sample Answer: I think its universal appeal comes down to a couple of things. Firstly, it just tastes wonderful and has a comforting quality that seems to make people feel good. Secondly, it's incredibly versatile; it can be an affordable daily treat for a child or a luxurious, high-end gift for an adult. This wide range means there's a type of chocolate for everyone.

Question: Did you often eat chocolate when you were a kid?

Sample Answer: Oh yes, I definitely had a sweet tooth when I was younger. I didn't eat it every single day, but it was always a special treat I looked forward to. My parents would often give it to me as a reward for doing well in school, or we'd have it during holidays and celebrations.

Question: How often do you eat chocolate?

Sample Answer: Not as often as I used to, that's for sure. Nowadays, I might have a small square of dark chocolate a few times a week, usually after dinner as a small indulgence. It's not something I snack on regularly, but more of a little treat to satisfy a craving every now and then.

Question: Do you like eating chocolate? Why or why not?

Sample Answer: Yes, I still do, but certainly in moderation. I really appreciate the rich, complex flavour of good quality chocolate. It feels like a simple pleasure and a nice way to treat myself at the end of a long day. I don't eat large quantities, but a small piece can be very satisfying.

Topic 20: Housework and cooking

Question: Do you do some cooking or help your family cook at home now?

Sample Answer: I definitely pitch in where I can. I wouldn't say I'm the main cook—my mother is amazing at it—but I often help with the preparation, like chopping vegetables or setting the table. I can handle some simple dishes myself, like fried rice or an omelette, for when I need something quick.

Question: Do you think your home is clean and tidy?

Sample Answer: Yes, for the most part. We all make an effort to chip in and do our share of the cleaning, so it's generally quite organised. It's not always perfectly spotless, of course, as life can get busy, but we try to maintain a comfortable and tidy living space.

Question: Did you do some house cleaning when you were young?

Sample Answer: Yes, I did. My parents assigned me specific chores from a young age. My main duties were to keep my own room tidy, take out the trash, and help with sweeping the floor. Although I didn't love it at the time, I think it instilled a good sense of responsibility in me.

Question: Do you have breakfast at home every day?

Sample Answer: I try my best to, especially on weekends. But during the workweek, if I'm running late, I'll often just grab something quick on my way to work. It's very common here to buy something like a *bánh mì* or some sticky rice from a street vendor for a fast and delicious breakfast.

Question: Do you want to learn how to cook well?

Sample Answer: Yes, absolutely. I think being able to cook properly is an essential life skill. It's not only healthier and more economical than always eating out, but it's also a wonderful creative outlet. I would love to be confident enough to host a dinner party for my friends one day.

Question: What housework do you like or dislike doing?

Sample Answer: That's an interesting question. I don't mind doing the laundry or washing the dishes; I find them quite methodical and I can listen to a podcast while I do them. However, I really dislike cleaning the bathroom. I just find it to be the most unpleasant and tedious chore, and I always put it off for as long as possible.

Topic 21: Public transportation

Question: What kind of public transportation do you usually take?

Sample Answer: I mostly use ride-hailing services like Grab for bike taxis, which is an incredibly common way to get around here. It's fast, affordable, and perfect for navigating the busy streets. If I'm travelling a longer distance across the city, I might take a public bus, but for my daily commute, the bike taxi is my go-to option.

Question: When do you usually take public transportation, in your everyday life or when you are travelling?

Sample Answer: It's definitely more a part of my everyday life for getting around the city, like for going to work or running errands. When I'm travelling to other provinces, I also use a form of public transport, but it's usually a long-distance coach or a train. So I suppose I use it for both, just in different forms and for different purposes.

Question: Do most people prefer public transportation in your country?

Sample Answer: Honestly, no. The vast majority of people in Vietnam prefer using their own private motorbikes. It's deeply ingrained in our culture as the most convenient and flexible way to travel. However, with the increasing traffic jams and the development of new systems like the metro in Ho Chi Minh City, I think attitudes are slowly starting to shift.

Question: Did you take public transportation when you were a kid?

Sample Answer: Yes, I did. My main experience was taking the school bus every day to my primary school. I also have fond memories of my dad taking me on the public city bus on weekends as a little adventure. It was exciting for me back then, just sitting by the window and watching the city go by.

Question: Will there be more people taking public transportation in the future?

Sample Answer: I certainly think so. As major cities get more congested and air pollution becomes a bigger concern, an efficient public transport system is becoming a necessity. With major investments in things like new bus routes and metro lines, I believe it will become a much more attractive and sustainable alternative for many people in the coming years.

Topic 22: Weather

Question: What do you think are the effects of climate change in recent years?

Sample Answer: I think the most noticeable effect is the increase in extreme weather events. Here in Vietnam, it feels like the rainy seasons are becoming more intense, which leads to more severe flooding. On top of that, the summers seem to be getting hotter and more prolonged. The weather just feels much more unpredictable than it did a decade ago.

Question: What's the weather like where you live?

Sample Answer: I live in Southern Vietnam, so we have a typical tropical monsoon climate. This basically means it's hot and humid for most of the year. We don't really have four seasons; instead, our weather is divided into two distinct seasons: a dry season, and a rainy season which usually lasts from about May to November.

Question: Do you prefer cold or hot weather?

Sample Answer: Although I'm accustomed to the heat, I have to say I much prefer cooler weather. I find it more comfortable, especially for outdoor activities, and I enjoy being able to wear layers like jackets or sweaters. The intense heat we often get can be quite draining and makes you feel lethargic, whereas cooler weather feels more energizing.

Question: Do you prefer dry or wet weather?

Sample Answer: Oh, dry weather, hands down. During the rainy season here, the heavy downpours can be very inconvenient. They often cause flash floods and terrible traffic jams, which makes getting around the city a real hassle. I definitely prefer the dry season when the skies are clear and I don't have to worry about getting soaked.

Question: Are you in the habit of checking the weather forecast? When and how often?

Sample Answer: Yes, it's a daily habit. I check a weather app on my phone first thing every morning. It helps me decide what to wear for the day and, more importantly during the rainy season, whether I need to pack a raincoat or an umbrella. It only takes a few seconds and it helps me avoid any unpleasant surprises.

Question: Would you like to visit other cities that have different climates from where you live?

Sample Answer: I would absolutely love to. Having lived in a tropical climate my entire life, I dream of visiting a place that experiences four distinct seasons. I'd love to see the leaves change color in autumn or experience a true, cold winter with snow. It would be a complete novelty for me and a very welcome change from the constant heat.

THE
FORUM

Topic 23: Birthday

Question: Whose birthday do you think is the most important to celebrate in Vietnam?

Sample Answer: In Vietnamese culture, a great deal of importance is placed on the birthdays of the elders in the family, like grandparents. Celebrating their birthday is a way of showing respect and filial piety, and it's often an occasion for a large family gathering. Also, a child's first birthday is considered a huge milestone and is celebrated in a big way.

Question: Do you think it is important for you to celebrate your birthday?

Sample Answer: For me, it's nice to mark the occasion, but it's not a hugely important event. I'm not really one for big parties or celebrations. I see it more as a good excuse to get together with my close friends or have a special dinner with my family. It's more about the company than the celebration itself.

Question: What did you do on your birthday when you were young?

Sample Answer: When I was a kid, it was usually a simple but happy family affair. My mom would cook my favourite meal, and the highlight was always getting a small birthday cake with candles to blow out. It was never anything extravagant, but those simple celebrations are very fond memories for me.

Question: What do you usually do on your birthday?

Sample Answer: It really varies from year to year. Sometimes I'll go out for a nice meal and a couple of drinks with a small group of my closest friends. Other years, if I prefer something more low-key, I'll just have a quiet, special dinner at home with my family. It all depends on how I'm feeling.

Topic 24: Writing

Question: What other methods do you use to record your life?

Sample Answer: My main method, besides any form of writing, is definitely taking photos. I'm a very visual person, so snapping a picture with my phone is the easiest and most immediate way to capture a moment or a memory. My phone's photo gallery essentially functions as my digital photo album, chronicling my life.

Question: How often do you keep diaries?

Sample Answer: I don't keep a traditional paper diary anymore, though I was quite diligent about it as a teenager. Nowadays, my journaling is much more sporadic. If something significant happens or if I need to process my thoughts, I might write a long entry in a notes app on my phone. It's more of a tool for reflection now.

Question: Do you prefer typing or handwriting when you are writing?

Sample Answer: For speed and efficiency, I prefer typing, hands down. It's much faster, and it's easy to edit and correct mistakes without making a mess. However, for something personal, like a birthday card or a thank-you note, I always choose to handwrite it. I feel it has more personality and shows more effort.

Question: Do you think the things you write would change?

Sample Answer: Yes, absolutely. I think what a person writes is a reflection of their mindset and experiences at a certain point in time. As I get older, my perspective and priorities will naturally evolve, so I'm sure the content and tone of my writing will change to reflect that personal growth.

Question: What do you like to write? Why?

Sample Answer: Most of my writing is very practical – things like professional emails or to-do lists to organize my day. I'm not much of a creative writer. However, I do enjoy taking the time to write a long, thoughtful message to a friend or family member. I find it's a good way to express my feelings more clearly than I could in a quick conversation.

Question: Do you write a lot?

Sample Answer: It depends on how you define 'writing'. If we're including typing messages and emails, then yes, I write constantly, all day long, for work and for social communication. But if we're talking about long-form writing, like essays or stories, then not so much anymore. Not really since I left university.

Topic 25: Names

Question: Does your name have any special meaning?

Sample Answer: Yes, it does. My given name is "Minh," which is a very common name in Vietnam for boys. It carries the meaning of 'bright', 'clear', or 'intelligent'. My parents chose it with the hope that I would be smart and have a bright, clear path in life. It's a nice sentiment that I appreciate.

Question: How would you choose names for your next generation?

Sample Answer: I think it would be a very thoughtful process for me. I'd want to choose a name that not only sounds beautiful but also carries a positive and strong meaning. It would be important to find something that reflects my hopes for my child's character and future. It would definitely be a collaborative decision with my partner to find the perfect name.

Question: Are there any differences between how Vietnamese name their children now and in the past?

Sample Answer: Yes, there's been a noticeable shift. In the past, names were often simpler and might have been chosen for traditional virtues. Nowadays, parents are much more creative and might look for more unique or poetic names. There's also a growing trend of choosing names that sound a bit more modern or are even gender-neutral, which was less common before.

Question: Does anyone in your family have the same name as you?

Sample Answer: No, not at all. In Vietnamese culture, it's generally considered a taboo to name a child after a living relative, especially an elder like a grandparent or parent. It's seen as disrespectful. As a result, pretty much everyone in my extended family has their own unique given name.

Question: Are there any names that are more popular than others in Vietnam?

Sample Answer: Yes, definitely. There are some timeless names that you hear everywhere because they have beautiful meanings. For girls, names like Linh, Anh, and Trang are incredibly popular. For boys, names like Minh, Huy, and Khoa are very common. These are classic choices that have stood the test of time.

Topic 26: Snacks

Question: What snacks do you like to eat?

Sample Answer: It really depends on my mood. If I'm craving something savory, I'll usually reach for a handful of roasted nuts or some rice crackers. If I have more of a sweet tooth, I prefer to eat fresh fruit like mangoes or pineapple, especially when they're in season. I find them much more refreshing than candy or cake.

Question: Did you often eat snacks when you were young?

Sample Answer: Oh yes, all the time. The after-school snack was practically a ritual for me and my friends. We used to love things like shrimp crackers, instant noodles, and all kinds of sweet dried fruit. We weren't very health-conscious back then; we just ate whatever tasted good.

Question: When do you usually eat snacks now?

Sample Answer: The most common time for me is in the mid-afternoon, around 3 PM at work. I usually experience a little dip in energy around then, and a small, healthy snack helps to keep me focused and get me through to dinnertime. I might also have something light in the evening while watching a movie.

Question: Do you think it is healthy for you to eat snacks?

Sample Answer: I think it entirely depends on the choice of snack. If you're eating fruits, nuts, or yogurt, then snacking can be a very healthy way to get nutrients and maintain your energy levels. However, if you're constantly reaching for chips, cookies, or sugary drinks, then it's obviously not good for you. Moderation and making smart choices are key.

Topic 27: Puzzles

Question: Do you think it is good for old people to do puzzles?

Sample Answer: Yes, I think it's absolutely beneficial. Puzzles act as a mental workout, which can help keep their minds active and sharp. I've read that engaging in activities like crosswords or Sudoku can help maintain cognitive skills and improve memory. Plus, it's an enjoyable and relaxing pastime for them.

Question: Do you like doing word puzzles or number puzzles? Which is more difficult for you?

Sample Answer: I'm definitely more of a word person, so I enjoy things like crosswords or word searches. I find playing with language and vocabulary quite fun and intuitive. Number puzzles like Sudoku, on the other hand, are much more difficult for me. I'm not very mathematically minded, so figuring out all the logic and patterns is a real challenge.

Question: When do you do puzzles, during your trip or when you feel bored?

Sample Answer: It's mostly when I'm looking for a quiet way to unwind and disconnect from screens, so I suppose that's when I feel a bit bored. I might do one on a lazy weekend afternoon. They're also great for long trips, like on a plane or a train, as they are a good way to pass the time without just staring at a screen.

Question: Did you do puzzles in your childhood?

Sample Answer: Yes, quite a lot. I have very fond memories of doing large jigsaw puzzles with my family on the living room floor; it was a great collaborative activity. I also remember loving the simple word searches and mazes that were in kids' magazines. It was always so satisfying to find the last word or reach the end of the maze.

Topic 28: Holidays

Question: Would you prefer an exciting holiday or a peaceful holiday?

Sample Answer: It really depends on my state of mind. Sometimes I crave an exciting holiday filled with adventure and exploring new places. But to be honest, after a hectic period at work, I usually prefer a peaceful getaway where I can just relax on a quiet beach, read a book, and recharge my batteries.

Question: Do you prefer a leisurely or a busy holiday?

Sample Answer: Oh, leisurely, without a doubt. For me, the whole point of a holiday is to have a break from my usually busy schedule. I'm not a fan of having a packed itinerary and rushing from one tourist attraction to another. I much prefer to have a loose plan and leave lots of room for spontaneity.

Question: Do you like to spend your day at home?

Sample Answer: If it's just a regular day off, like a Sunday, then yes, I enjoy having a lazy day at home to just chill out and do nothing. But if I'm on a proper holiday, especially if I've traveled somewhere new, I definitely want to be out and about. I'd feel like I was wasting the opportunity if I just stayed indoors.

Question: What do you do on holidays?

Sample Answer: It's usually a combination of resting and socializing. I try to catch up on sleep and then use the free time to meet up with friends I haven't seen in a while. If it's a longer holiday, like the Tet holiday, I'll usually take a short trip to another city or to the coast with my family.

Question: Which public holiday do you like best?

Sample Answer: That's easy – it has to be the Tet holiday, our Lunar New Year. It's the longest and most significant holiday in Vietnam. It's a wonderful time for family reunions, enjoying lots of traditional food, and just soaking up the festive atmosphere. Everyone gets a nice long break from work, so it's a very cherished time of year.

Question: Do you like holidays? Why?

Sample Answer: Yes, absolutely. I think they're essential for everyone. They provide a much-needed break from the daily grind and the routine of work. It's a chance to de-stress, recharge your batteries, and spend quality time with the people you care about. Life would be very monotonous without them.

Question: Where did you go for your last holiday?

Sample Answer: My last proper holiday was a few months ago. I went on a four-day trip to Da Lat with some of my close friends. It was a wonderful escape from the heat of my city. We spent our time exploring the beautiful scenery, visiting coffee plantations, and just enjoying the cool, fresh air. It was very relaxing.

THE
FORUM

Topic 29: List

Question: Do you prefer to make a list on paper or your phone?

Sample Answer: I definitely prefer using my phone, hands down. It's just so much more convenient since I always have it with me. I use a notes app where I can easily add or delete items as I go. With a paper list, I find I'm much more likely to lose it or accidentally leave it at home.

Question: Why don't some people like making lists?

Sample Answer: I suppose it could be for a few reasons. Some people might feel that a list is too rigid or restrictive and they prefer to be more spontaneous. Others might just have a fantastic memory and feel they don't need the extra help. And for some, it probably just feels like a tedious and unnecessary chore.

Question: Do you make a list for your work? Does it work?

Sample Answer: Yes, absolutely. It's an essential part of my daily routine. I start each morning by creating a to-do list to prioritize my tasks. It works wonders for me because it helps me stay focused and ensures I don't forget anything important. Plus, ticking things off as I complete them gives me a great sense of accomplishment.

Question: Do you make a list when you shop?

Sample Answer: Always, especially for grocery shopping. If I don't, I inevitably forget one or two crucial items and usually end up making a lot of impulse buys. Having a list keeps me on track, helps me stick to a budget, and makes the whole shopping trip much quicker and more efficient.

Topic 30: Spending time by yourself

Question: Do you usually spend time by yourself?

Sample Answer: Yes, I do. I think it's really important to have some regular 'me time'. With a busy work and social life, I find that spending a few hours alone is essential for me to de-stress and recharge my social batteries. It helps me maintain a sense of balance in my life.

Question: How do you usually spend your time by yourself?

Sample Answer: It's usually something quiet and relaxing. I might curl up on the sofa with a good book, listen to a full music album without interruptions, or watch a movie that my friends might not be interested in. It's all about doing things at my own pace and just enjoying the peace and quiet.

Question: Do you like spending time by yourself?

Sample Answer: Yes, very much so. I really value it. It gives me the chance to clear my head, process my thoughts, and just be with myself without any external pressures. For me, it's not about feeling lonely at all; it's about enjoying my own company and finding a moment of calm.

Question: What did you do last time you were by yourself?

Sample Answer: Let me think... just last night, actually. I had a quiet evening in. I ordered my favourite takeaway, put on some relaxing music, and just spent a couple of hours getting lost in a novel I'm reading. It was very simple, but it was the perfect way for me to unwind after a busy week.

Topic 31: Singing

Question: Do you think singing can bring happiness to people?

Sample Answer: Yes, without a doubt. I think singing is a very powerful way to express and experience emotion. Whether you're singing your heart out when you're alone, or singing together with a group of friends at a karaoke bar, it can be incredibly uplifting. It's a great way to release stress and it definitely brings a sense of joy.

Question: Who do you want to sing for?

Sample Answer: To be perfectly honest, I'm a terrible singer, so I wouldn't dare to sing for a serious audience. If I'm singing, it's just for fun with my close friends in a very casual setting, like at a karaoke bar. In that kind of non-judgmental atmosphere, it's not about performing well, it's just about having a laugh together.

Question: Have you ever learnt how to sing?

Sample Answer: Not formally, no. We had some general music classes in primary school where singing was a part of the curriculum, but that's as far as it went. I've never had any professional vocal training or taken any proper singing lessons. So my singing ability, or rather my lack of it, is all natural!

Question: Do you like singing? Why?

Sample Answer: Yes, I do like the act of singing, but I'm quite self-conscious about my voice. Therefore, I mostly enjoy singing when I'm by myself, like when I'm driving or in the shower. I can sing along to my favourite songs at the top of my lungs, and it feels great because I know nobody is judging me.

Topic 32: Hobby

Question: Do you have the same hobbies as your family members?

Sample Answer: Not really, we all have quite different interests. For instance, my father is a keen gardener and can spend hours outside, while my mother loves to cook and experiment with new recipes. I'm more into reading and fitness. We find common ground in things like watching movies, but our individual hobbies are quite distinct.

Question: Do you have a hobby that you've had since childhood?

Sample Answer: Yes, reading. I've loved getting lost in books for as long as I can remember. It started with children's stories and comic books when I was very young, and it has just stuck with me ever since. Of course, my taste in literature has evolved over the years, but the act of reading has been a constant passion.

Question: Did you have any hobbies when you were a child?

Sample Answer: Yes, I did. Besides reading, I went through a phase where I was really into collecting stamps. I was fascinated by the different pictures and countries. I also played a lot of badminton with my neighbourhood friends; that was probably my main outdoor hobby and how I spent most of my afternoons.

Question: Do you have any hobbies?

Sample Answer: Yes, my main hobbies at the moment are reading and trying to keep fit, so I go to the gym a few times a week. I also really enjoy café-hopping on the weekends. Exploring new coffee shops with interesting designs or unique drinks has become a fun way for me to relax and catch up with friends.

Topic 33: Books and reading habits

Question: Do you often buy books?

Sample Answer: Not as often as I used to. I love the feel of a physical book, so I'll still buy a copy if it's by an author I love or if the cover is particularly beautiful. However, for the most part, I've shifted towards reading e-books on my tablet. It's just more convenient for a daily commute and often a bit cheaper.

Question: Which do you prefer, reading books or watching movies?

Sample Answer: That's a tough one as I enjoy both. They offer very different experiences. If I'm in the mood for a deep, immersive story where I can use my imagination, I'll always choose a book. But if I'm tired and just want some easy, visual entertainment to help me relax, then a movie is the perfect choice.

Question: Have you ever read a novel that has been adapted into a film?

Sample Answer: Yes, many times. The *Harry Potter* series is probably the most famous example for my generation. I almost always prefer the book to the film adaptation. A book can go into so much more detail about the world and the characters' inner thoughts, which a two-hour film often has to cut out for the sake of time.

Question: Are your reading habits now different than before?

Sample Answer: Yes, completely. When I was a student, I had much more free time, so I could read fiction for hours on end. Nowadays, with a full-time job, my reading is done in shorter bursts – maybe for half an hour before I go to sleep. I also read a much wider range of materials, including a lot of news and articles online.

Question: Do you often read books? When?

Sample Answer: Yes, I try to read every day, even if it's just for a short while. My favourite time to read is at night, just before I go to sleep. I find it's a great way to unwind and disconnect from the day's stresses. It's a much more relaxing ritual than scrolling through my phone.

Question: Do you read more or less now than when you were younger?

Sample Answer: That's an interesting question. In terms of novels for pleasure, I definitely read less now just due to a lack of free time. However, if you include all the articles, reports, and emails I read for work and to stay informed, I probably read a much higher volume of words overall. The nature of my reading has just shifted from leisure to necessity.

Topic 34: Computers/tablets

Question: Would you like to use a computer or tablet?

Sample Answer: It depends entirely on the task at hand. For any serious work that requires a lot of typing or multitasking, I would always choose my laptop because of its physical keyboard and larger screen. However, for casual use like Browse the web, reading, or watching movies on the sofa, a tablet is much more convenient and comfortable.

Question: In what conditions would you use a computer or tablet?

Sample Answer: I typically use my computer when I'm at a desk, either at home or in the office. It's for when I need to sit down and focus properly on a task. A tablet, on the other hand, is perfect for more relaxed settings – when I'm lounging on the sofa, travelling on a train, or sitting in a café. It's much better for on-the-go situations.

Question: When was the first time you used a computer or tablet?

Sample Answer: The first time I used a computer was back in primary school, probably when I was about eight or nine. We had a computer lab, and I vividly remember being taught how to use Microsoft Paint. It felt incredibly high-tech and futuristic at the time. It's amazing to think how much technology has advanced since then.

Question: What would your life be like without computers or tablets?

Sample Answer: Honestly, it's almost unimaginable. My life would be completely different and much more difficult. I rely on my computer for work, for staying in touch with friends and family, for entertainment, and for information. I think I would feel very disconnected from the world and my productivity would drop significantly.

Question: In what conditions would it be difficult for you to use a computer or tablet?

Sample Answer: Well, the most obvious condition would be somewhere without electricity or a stable internet connection. It's also very tricky to use them outdoors in bright, direct sunlight, as the glare makes the screen almost impossible to see. Also, trying to use a laptop on a really crowded bus or train would be a struggle with no elbow room.

Topic 35: Mobile phone

Question: Have you ever lost your mobile phone?

Sample Answer: Touch wood, I've never completely lost one for good. I have had a few moments of pure panic where I thought I'd left it in a café or a taxi, and my heart just sinks. But luckily, each time I've managed to find it or get it back. It's always a huge sense of relief.

Question: How has your mobile phone changed your life?

Sample Answer: It has changed my life in countless ways. It's become an indispensable tool that I use for almost everything – communication, navigation, banking, entertainment, and photography. It's made life incredibly convenient. The only downside is that you're always connected and reachable, so it can be hard to switch off.

Question: Will you buy a new one in the future?

Sample Answer: Eventually, yes, but not anytime soon. My current phone is working perfectly fine, and I'm not the type of person who needs to upgrade to the latest model every year. I'll probably only consider buying a new one when my current phone starts getting too slow or the battery life really degrades.

Question: Do you often use your mobile phone for texting or calls?

Sample Answer: I use it for texting far more often than for making calls. For me, instant messaging on apps like Zalo or Messenger is the default way to communicate with friends and colleagues. It's just quicker and less intrusive. I typically only make a phone call if the matter is urgent or formal.

Question: What was your first mobile phone?

Sample Answer: My very first phone was a classic Nokia, one of those little indestructible phones that people now call 'brick phones'. All it could do was make calls and send basic texts, but I loved it. I vividly remember playing the game 'Snake' on it for hours. The battery also lasted for about a week, which is unimaginable now.

Topic 36: App

Question: What kind of apps do you spend money on?

Sample Answer: To be honest, I'm quite frugal, so I don't spend money on many apps. The main ones I pay for are subscription services for entertainment, like Spotify for my music or Netflix for movies. Occasionally, I might make a one-time purchase for a high-quality productivity app if it has great reviews, but that's quite rare.

Question: What apps don't you use anymore?

Sample Answer: There are quite a few, mostly games that I downloaded on a whim and then got bored of after a few days. Also, some trendy photo-editing apps that I used once or twice for a specific filter. They just end up sitting on my phone, cluttering the screen and taking up valuable storage space, so I try to delete them every now and then.

Question: What apps do you still use?

Sample Answer: My most essential apps are definitely my communication apps, like Zalo and Messenger, which I use to talk to everyone. I also use my mobile banking app almost daily. Besides those, Google Maps for navigation and a weather app are my daily drivers. I really couldn't get through my day without them.

Question: What kind of apps have you downloaded on your phone?

Sample Answer: I've got a whole range of them, but they mainly fall into a few categories. I have the usual social media apps like Facebook and Instagram; some entertainment apps like YouTube and Spotify; utility apps like my calendar and a translator; and a couple for health and fitness. It's a pretty standard collection for most people, I think.

Topic 37: Young people/teenagers

Question: Do you like spending time with teenagers?

Sample Answer: Yes, in small doses, I do. They have a lot of energy and enthusiasm, and they keep me up-to-date with the latest trends, which is quite fun. However, I sometimes feel there's a bit of a generation gap, so I find it can be a little tiring if I spend too much time with them.

Question: Do you care about teenagers' fashion trends?

Sample Answer: I wouldn't say I *care* in the sense that I want to follow them myself, but I am aware of them. It's interesting to observe what's popular, like the current trend for very baggy clothes or certain brands of sneakers. I find it fascinating to see how styles change, even if they're not for me.

Question: Do you know what the fashion trend among young people is like in your country?

Sample Answer: Yes, it seems to be heavily influenced by Korean pop culture and streetwear. You see a lot of oversized hoodies, baggy trousers, and chunky sneakers. Also, social media platforms like TikTok have a huge impact, so a particular style or item can become incredibly popular almost overnight.

Question: What activities do young people like to do in your country?

Sample Answer: A lot of their social life seems to revolve around hanging out in cafés and milk tea shops; those places are always packed with teenagers. They also love going to the cinema and shopping malls. And, of course, taking photos for Instagram or TikTok is a massive activity, so finding cool, photogenic spots is very popular.

Topic 38: Party

Question: Do you prefer to go to small parties or big parties?

Sample Answer: I definitely prefer small parties, hands down. I sometimes find big, crowded parties a bit overwhelming, and it's hard to have a proper conversation with the music being so loud. I much prefer more intimate gatherings with close friends where you can actually relax and connect with people properly.

Question: Have you been to a party recently?

Sample Answer: Yes, just last weekend, actually. A colleague of mine was leaving the company, so we threw a small farewell party for her at a restaurant. It was a really nice evening – just a small group of us sharing stories and wishing her well for the future.

Question: Have you ever organized a party?

Sample Answer: Yes, a few times, but only small ones. I've organized birthday dinners for my friends and for myself before. It can be quite a lot of work, coordinating with everyone and booking a place, but it's always very rewarding when you see everyone having a good time and enjoying themselves.

Question: How often did you have a party when you were a kid?

Sample Answer: Not very often, really. The main occasion for a party was my birthday each year. It was usually a very simple affair at my house with my family and a few of my closest school friends. We'd just play some games and have birthday cake. It was very low-key.

Question: Do you like parties?

Sample Answer: It depends on the kind of party. I really enjoy small get-togethers with people I know well. It's a great way to socialize and catch up. However, I'm not a huge fan of big, loud club-style parties where you can't hear anyone speak. I tend to feel a bit out of place in that kind of environment.

Topic 39: Fishing

Question: Did you ever go fishing when you were a child?

Sample Answer: Yes, I did go a few times with my uncle. He was a keen fisherman and would sometimes take me along to a local river on the weekends. To be honest, I was too impatient to be very good at it, but I have very fond memories of just sitting there with him and enjoying the quiet time together.

Question: Do you like fishing?

Sample Answer: I can appreciate why people enjoy the peacefulness of it, but it's not really my cup of tea. I find it a little bit too slow-paced for my personality; I think I lack the patience that's required to sit and wait for hours. I generally prefer hobbies that are a bit more active.

Question: Do you like eating fish?

Sample Answer: Oh yes, absolutely. Fish is a staple part of the Vietnamese diet, and I love it. There are so many delicious ways it's prepared here. I'm especially fond of grilled fish with fresh herbs, and a traditional sweet and sour fish soup called *canh chua*. It's healthy and incredibly tasty.

Question: Is fishing popular in your country?

Sample Answer: Yes, it's very popular in different forms. You often see people fishing recreationally along rivers and canals, especially on the weekends. A more modern trend is the rise of 'fishing cafés', where you pay a fee to fish in a stocked pond, and they can even cook whatever you catch. It's a popular social activity now.

Topic 40: Teachers

Question: Do you want to be a teacher in the future?

Sample Answer: While I have a huge amount of respect for the teaching profession, I don't think it's the right career path for me. It requires a special kind of patience and dedication that I'm not sure I possess. I think it's an incredibly important job, but it's just not my calling.

Question: Do you have a teacher from your past that you still remember?

Sample Answer: Yes, I vividly remember my high school literature teacher. She was incredibly passionate about the subject, and her enthusiasm was just infectious. She had a wonderful way of making the stories and poems we studied feel relevant and exciting. She really stands out in my memory.

Question: Are you still in touch with your primary school teachers?

Sample Answer: Unfortunately, no. It's been such a long time, and I've just lost touch with them over the years. People move on, and life gets busy. I might occasionally see an update about one of them on social media through a mutual friend, but we're not in direct contact anymore.

Question: In what way has your favourite teacher helped you?

Sample Answer: My favourite literature teacher helped me most by building my self-confidence. She was the first person to really praise my writing and make me feel like I had a talent for it. Her encouragement meant a lot and it wasn't just about the subject; it helped me to believe in my own abilities in general.

Question: Do you have a favorite teacher?

Sample Answer: Yes, as I've mentioned, my high school literature teacher. She was my favourite because her passion for the subject was contagious, and she genuinely cared about her students' progress, not just our exam scores. She treated us like individuals and made a lasting, positive impression on me.

Topic 41: Staying at home

Question: What do you like to do in your free time when you're at home?

Sample Answer: When I have free time at home, I mostly like to unwind and do relaxing things. My go-to activities are reading a good book, listening to a podcast, or binge-watching a TV series that I'm into. It's my chance to switch off my brain and de-stress after a busy week at work.

Question: Would you like to stay at home a lot in the future?

Sample Answer: I think I'll always appreciate having a healthy balance. I love my time at home and need it to recharge, but I also love being out, socializing, and travelling. A life spent only at home would become a bit monotonous for me. So, I need a good mix of both staying in and going out.

Question: What did you often do at home as a child?

Sample Answer: Apart from my homework, I remember I used to watch a lot of cartoons on TV after school. I also played a lot of video games on our old family console with my brother. On rainy days, I would spend hours just reading comic books or building things with my Lego set.

Question: What is your favourite place at home?

Sample Answer: That would definitely be my own bedroom. It's my personal sanctuary where I can shut the door, be myself, and completely relax. It's quiet and cozy, and it's where I keep all my books and my favourite things. It's the one place I can truly escape from the stresses of the outside world.

Question: What do you do when you stay at home?

Sample Answer: It's usually a combination of being productive and being lazy. I'll try to get some household chores done, like cleaning or doing the laundry. Once the practical stuff is out of the way, I'll do something to relax, like cook a nice meal, watch a movie, or just catch up with my friends online.

Question: Are you a person who likes to stay at home?

Sample Answer: Yes, I'd say I am. I'm quite a homebody. Although I enjoy going out and being social, I also genuinely love the peace and comfort of my own space. I never feel restless or bored when I'm at home; for me, it's a peaceful sanctuary, and I'm very content to have a quiet night in.

Topic 42: Music/Musical instruments

Question: Do schools in your country have music lessons?

Sample Answer: Yes, they do. Music is a compulsory subject in primary and lower secondary school here. The lessons usually cover the basics of music theory, like reading notes, and a lot of singing. It's not always very in-depth, but it provides all students with a fundamental introduction to music.

Question: Do a lot of people like music?

Sample Answer: Oh, absolutely. I think it's safe to say music is a universal passion. It's a huge part of everyday life in Vietnam; you hear it everywhere, from cafés and shops to on the bus. People use it to energize themselves, to relax after a long day, or just to have some background noise while they work.

Question: Do you think music education is important for children?

Sample Answer: Yes, I believe it's incredibly important for a child's development. It's not just about learning an instrument; music education fosters creativity, teaches discipline and perseverance, and it's a wonderful outlet for emotional expression. I think it contributes to a much more well-rounded education.

Question: Do you think children should learn to play an instrument at school?

Sample Answer: I think they should definitely have the opportunity to learn, perhaps as an optional class or an after-school club. However, I don't think it should be compulsory. Learning an instrument requires a lot of dedication, and forcing a child might be counter-productive and could make them end up disliking it.

Question: What musical instruments do you enjoy listening to the most?

Sample Answer: The two instruments that come to mind immediately are the piano and the acoustic guitar. I find them both to be incredibly versatile. A piano can sound so grand and powerful, but also very delicate and emotional. And the sound of a simple acoustic guitar is just so warm and comforting to me.

Question: Have you ever learned to play a musical instrument?

Sample Answer: I attempted to learn the guitar for a little while when I was a teenager. I bought a cheap acoustic guitar and learned a few basic chords from the internet. But to be honest, I wasn't disciplined enough with my practice, so I gave up after a few months. I kind of regret not sticking with it.

Topic 43: Gifts

Question: What gift have you received recently?

Sample Answer: The most recent one was for my birthday last month. My best friend gave me a subscription to a coffee delivery service. It was such a thoughtful gift because she knows how much I love trying different types of coffee. It was a really lovely and unexpected surprise.

Question: Do you think you are good at choosing gifts?

Sample Answer: I'd like to think so. I try to be very observant and put a lot of thought into it. I listen for any hints people might drop in conversation leading up to an occasion, and I think about their hobbies and what they genuinely need. My goal is to always find something that is both personal and practical.

Question: What do you consider when choosing a gift?

Sample Answer: The main thing I consider is the recipient's personality and our relationship. I think about what they like, what they need, and what would make them smile. The occasion is also important, of course, as a birthday gift is different from a thank-you gift. And finally, my budget is also a practical factor I have to consider.

Question: Have you ever received a great gift?

Sample Answer: Yes, for my university graduation, my parents gave me a really good-quality watch. It was a fantastic gift, not just because it was a beautiful item, but because of its sentimental value. It was their way of marking a major milestone in my life, and I wear it almost every day as a fond reminder.

Question: Have you ever sent handmade gifts to others?

Sample Answer: I wish I could say yes, but I have to admit that I'm not very crafty or artistic. I truly admire people who can create beautiful handmade gifts because it's such a personal and meaningful gesture. However, my skills just aren't up to scratch, and I'd be afraid of making something that looks clumsy!

Topic 44: The city you live in

Question: What city do you live in?

Sample Answer: I live in Bien Hoa city, which is the capital of Dong Nai province here in Vietnam. It's a pretty large and bustling industrial city, and it's located right next to Ho Chi Minh City, so it's quite a busy, well-connected area.

Question: Do you like this city? Why?

Sample Answer: Yes, I really do. It has all the conveniences of a big city, like shopping malls and a great food scene, but the pace of life feels a little more relaxed than in Ho Chi Minh City. The people here are very down-to-earth, and it has a strong community feel which I appreciate.

Question: How long have you lived in this city?

Sample Answer: I've lived here my entire life. I was born and raised in Bien Hoa, so I know the city like the back of my hand. It's been fascinating to watch it grow and change so much over the years, from a smaller town into the major city it is today.

Question: Are there big changes in this city?

Sample Answer: Yes, massive changes, especially in the last decade. There's been a huge amount of development, with new high-rise apartment buildings, modern shopping malls, and better roads. The city has expanded rapidly, and some areas are almost unrecognizable compared to how they were when I was a kid.

Question: Is this city your permanent residence?

Sample Answer: For now, yes. My family and my current job are all here, so this is very much my home base. I'm open to the possibility of moving elsewhere for a fantastic career opportunity in the future, but for the foreseeable future, I see myself staying in Bien Hoa.

Question: Are there people of different ages living in this city?

Sample Answer: Yes, absolutely. It has a very diverse population in terms of age. There are many young families who move here for work in the industrial parks, a large student population because of the universities, and of course, the older generation who have lived here their whole lives. It's a good cross-section of society.

Question: Are the people friendly in the city?

Sample Answer: Yes, generally speaking, I think they are. People here tend to be quite welcoming and down-to-earth. It's a large city, but it doesn't feel as anonymous as some other mega-cities. If you're lost or need help, people are usually very willing to assist you.

Question: Is the city friendly to children and old people?

Sample Answer: I'd say it's improving. For children, there are more public parks, playgrounds, and family-friendly cafes than there used to be. It can be a bit challenging for the elderly because of the busy traffic, but there are also many quiet spaces and community centers where they can socialize.

Question: Do you often see your neighbors?

Sample Answer: Yes, quite often. I live in a neighborhood where people tend to know each other, at least by sight. We always exchange a greeting or a nod when we see each other outside, and sometimes we'll stop for a quick chat. It's a nice, friendly atmosphere.

Question: What's the weather like where you live?

Sample Answer: We have a typical tropical monsoon climate. This means it's hot and humid for most of the year. We don't have the four distinct seasons like in temperate countries; instead, our weather is divided into just two: a rainy season, which lasts from about May to November, and a dry season.

Question: Would you recommend your city to others?

Sample Answer: Yes, I would, especially for travellers who want a more authentic Vietnamese experience. It's not a major tourist destination, so you can see the local way of life more clearly. The food scene is fantastic and it's a great base for exploring the wider Dong Nai province.

Topic 45: T-shirt

Question: Did you often wear T-shirts when you were a child?

Sample Answer: Yes, practically all the time. A T-shirt and a pair of shorts was my daily uniform as a kid, especially because of the hot weather here. They're just so comfortable and practical for playing outside. I remember having a large collection of them, many with my favourite cartoon characters on the front.

Question: Would you buy T-shirts as souvenirs on vacation?

Sample Answer: I used to, but I don't really do that anymore. I've found that souvenir T-shirts are often not very good quality, and they tend to shrink or fade after a few washes. Nowadays, I prefer to buy souvenirs that are a bit more authentic to the local culture, like handicrafts or specialty food items.

Question: Do you think older people who wear T-shirts are fashionable?

Sample Answer: Of course. I think a T-shirt is a timeless piece of clothing that suits everyone, regardless of age. It all depends on the style and the fit. A simple, high-quality, well-fitting T-shirt can look very classic and stylish on an older person. It's definitely not just for the young.

Question: Do you like T-shirts with pictures or prints?

Sample Answer: For the most part, I prefer plain, solid-color T-shirts. I find they are much more versatile and easier to pair with other items in my wardrobe. I'm not a huge fan of T-shirts with very large pictures or prominent brand logos; I find that style a bit too loud for my personal taste. I prefer a more minimalist look.

Question: How often do you wear T-shirts?

Sample Answer: Very frequently, I'd say. They are my go-to item for casual wear, especially on weekends or for relaxing at home in the evenings. Given the hot and humid climate here in Southern Vietnam, a comfortable cotton T-shirt is pretty much the most practical choice for most of the year.

Question: Do you like wearing T-shirts?

Sample Answer: Yes, I love them. For me, they're the perfect basic item of clothing. They are incredibly comfortable, versatile, and very easy to wash and take care of. You can dress them up with a nice jacket or keep things super casual. I think they're an essential item in anyone's wardrobe.

Topic 46: Weekends

Question: Has your weekend routine changed?

Sample Answer: Yes, it's changed quite a bit since I started working full-time. When I was a student, my weekends often involved a lot of studying or going out with friends. Now, my weekends are much more focused on relaxing, catching up on household chores, and generally just recovering from a busy work week.

Question: Do you do the same things every weekend?

Sample Answer: Not exactly the same, but there's usually a general pattern. I always try to get some exercise and meet up with friends at some point. However, the specific activities change depending on the weather or what my friends are up to. I like to keep things flexible rather than having a rigid schedule.

Question: Do you make plans for your weekends?

Sample Answer: I tend to make loose plans. I don't schedule every single hour, but I might arrange to meet a friend for dinner on Saturday or decide which morning I'll do my weekly shopping. Having a rough idea helps me make the most of the weekend, while still leaving plenty of room for spontaneity.

Question: What did you do last weekend?

Sample Answer: Last Saturday, I went to a café in the morning with a friend, and then I just ran some errands in the afternoon. Sunday was a much quieter day. I did a big clean of my apartment and then in the evening, I just relaxed on the sofa and watched a couple of movies. It was a nice, balanced weekend.

Question: What do you usually do on weekends? Do you study or work?

Sample Answer: I try my best to avoid working or studying on weekends. For me, that time is sacred for unwinding and recharging my batteries. My typical weekend activities include catching up with friends, pursuing my hobbies like reading, getting some exercise, and just mentally preparing for the week ahead.

Question: Do you like weekends?

Sample Answer: Yes, absolutely. I look forward to them all week. They're a much-needed break from the daily grind and the structure of the workweek. I love having those two days of freedom to do things at my own pace, whether that's being productive or just doing nothing at all.

Topic 47: Electronic devices/Technology

Question: What kind of apps have you downloaded on your phone?

Sample Answer: I have a whole host of them, but they mainly fall into a few key categories. There are the essential communication apps like Zalo and Messenger, entertainment apps like YouTube and Spotify, and then various utility apps like my mobile banking, a map application, and my calendar.

Question: What technology do you often use, computers or cellphones?

Sample Answer: I use both extensively every single day, but for different reasons. My laptop is my workhorse; I use it for focused tasks that require a lot of typing and a big screen. My cellphone, on the other hand, is my tool for constant communication and for when I'm on the move. They really complement each other perfectly.

Question: What electronic devices have you bought lately?

Sample Answer: The most recent purchase I made was a pair of noise-cancelling headphones. They've been an absolute game-changer for me. They help me block out distractions so I can focus better when I'm working, and they make listening to music and podcasts on my commute so much more enjoyable.

Question: Is there any technology you want to buy?

Sample Answer: Yes, I've been eyeing a smart watch for a while. I'm quite interested in tracking my fitness and sleep patterns more accurately. Also, the convenience of getting notifications at a glance without having to constantly pull my phone out of my pocket is very appealing to me.

Question: Is technology important in your life?

Sample Answer: Yes, incredibly so. It's almost impossible to imagine modern life without it. Technology is completely integrated into every aspect of my day, from how I work and study, to how I socialize and entertain myself. It has made life more efficient and connected in countless ways.

Question: Is there any technology you don't like?

Sample Answer: I'm not a huge fan of virtual reality headsets. I've tried them a couple of times, and while I can see that the technology is impressive, I find the experience to be quite isolating. It can also make me feel a little dizzy. I prefer technology that enhances my connection to the real world, rather than takes me out of it.

Question: What do you think are the trends in technology today compared to when you were young?

Sample Answer: The biggest trends today are definitely mobility and interconnectivity. When I was a kid, technology was a stationary desktop computer in one room. Now, powerful technology is in our pockets, in our watches, and all our devices are connected to each other through the internet. The rise of artificial intelligence in everyday apps is also a massive change.

THE
FORUM

Topic 48: Doing sports

Question: What exercise did you do as a kid that you don't do anymore?

Sample Answer: When I was a kid, I used to play a lot of shuttlecock kicking, or *đá cầu* as it's called in Vietnamese. It was incredibly popular in my school playground, and we'd play it every break time. I was quite good at it, but I haven't played it in years. It's just not a common activity for adults to do casually.

Question: Do you know any schoolmates who are good at sports?

Sample Answer: Yes, I vividly remember a boy in my high school class who was an amazing football player. He was the star player on the school team and was just so naturally talented and athletic. He could run faster and seemed to have better control of the ball than anyone else. Everyone really admired him.

Question: Should schools encourage young students to take more physical exercise?

Sample Answer: Yes, absolutely. I think it's more important now than ever before. With many kids leading quite a sedentary lifestyle because of smartphones and computers, schools have a crucial role to play. Encouraging regular exercise is vital not just for physical health, but also for mental well-being and stress relief.

Question: Do you think it is important for people to exercise?

Sample Answer: Yes, it's absolutely vital for a healthy life. It's not just about managing your weight; it's crucial for your cardiovascular health, for boosting your energy levels, and for your mental clarity. I think regular physical activity significantly improves your overall quality of life.

Question: Do you think students need more exercise?

Sample Answer: Without a doubt. Students, especially in high school, are often under a great deal of academic pressure and they spend many hours a day sitting down to study. More physical exercise would be a fantastic outlet for their stress and would probably even help them to concentrate better in their lessons.

Question: Did you do some sports when you were young?

Sample Answer: Yes, the main sport I played regularly was badminton. It was very popular in my neighbourhood because it was so accessible. We didn't need a proper court; we could just set up a makeshift net in the alley next to my house and play for hours after school.

Question: Where did you learn how to do it?

Sample Answer: I was mostly self-taught, really. I didn't have a formal coach or take any lessons. I just learned by playing with my friends and by observing the older kids in my neighbourhood who were better than me. We would watch how they played and then try to copy their techniques. It was a lot of trial and error.

Question: What sports do you like?

Sample Answer: These days, I'm not much of a team sports person, but I'm a huge fan of watching football, especially big tournaments like the World Cup. When it comes to participating myself, I prefer individual activities. I enjoy going to the gym and swimming because I can do them at my own pace and on my own schedule.

THE
FORUM

Topic 49: Morning routines

Question: Do you like to get up early in the morning?

Sample Answer: To be perfectly honest, I'm not a natural morning person; I'm more of a night owl by nature. So, waking up early on weekdays is something I do out of necessity because of work, not because I particularly enjoy it. However, I do appreciate how quiet and peaceful the world is at that time of day.

Question: What is your morning routine?

Sample Answer: On a typical workday, my routine is pretty consistent. I wake up, spend a few minutes checking messages on my phone, then I'll have a quick shower and get dressed. After that, making a strong cup of coffee is absolutely essential. I'll usually have a light breakfast, like some toast or fruit, before I head out the door.

Question: Is breakfast important?

Sample Answer: Yes, I firmly believe it is. I think it's the most important meal of the day because it kick-starts your metabolism and gives you the energy you need to start your day properly. I definitely notice a big difference in my concentration levels and mood if I ever have to skip it.

Question: What do you do right after getting up in the morning?

Sample Answer: The very first thing I do is switch off the alarm on my phone. And I have to admit, the next thing I do is lie in bed for a few minutes and check my notifications and maybe the news headlines. It's probably not the healthiest way to start the day, but it's a habit I've gotten into.

Topic 50: Work or Studies

Path A: Work

Question: What work do you do?

Sample Answer: I work as a marketing executive for a consumer goods company here in Bien Hoa. My main responsibilities involve planning and running digital campaigns, analysing market data, and collaborating with the sales team to promote our products effectively.

Question: Why did you choose to do that type of work (or that job)?

Sample Answer: I majored in Business Administration at university, and I was always drawn to the marketing modules. I love that it's a field that combines both creativity and data analysis. You get to be creative with campaigns, but you also have to be analytical about the results, and that mix really appealed to me.

Question: Do you like your job?

Sample Answer: Yes, I do, for the most part. Like any job, it has its stressful days, especially when deadlines are tight. But overall, it's very rewarding. I enjoy the challenge, there's a great sense of accomplishment when a campaign is successful, and I work with a very supportive team.

Question: What requirements did you need to meet to get your current job?

Sample Answer: The main requirement was a bachelor's degree in a relevant field, like business or marketing. They also looked for some prior internship experience to show that I had some practical understanding. During the interview process, I also had to demonstrate strong communication and analytical skills.

Question: Do you have any plans for your work in the next five years?

Sample Answer: Yes, my main goal is career progression. Over the next five years, I hope to gain more expertise in digital marketing and take on more responsibility, perhaps leading my own projects. Ideally, I'd like to be in a senior or managerial role within my department.

Question: What do you think is the most important at the moment?

Sample Answer: At this stage of my career, the most important thing is gaining as much practical experience as possible. I'm focused on learning from my senior colleagues, building a strong skill set, and understanding the industry inside and out. I believe this is the foundation for long-term success.

Question: Do you want to change to another job?

Sample Answer: Not at the moment, no. I'm quite content where I am, and I feel there's still plenty of room for me to grow and learn within my current company. Of course, I'll always keep my options open for the future, but I have no immediate plans to look for another job.

Question: Do you miss being a student?

Sample Answer: Sometimes I do. I miss the long holidays and the more relaxed social life. However, I definitely don't miss the stress of exams and assignments. I really enjoy the financial independence and the sense of purpose that comes with working, so I wouldn't want to go back to being a student.

Question: What technology do you use at work?

Sample Answer: We use a whole range of technology daily. My laptop is my main tool, of course. We use communication platforms like Microsoft Teams to collaborate, project management software like Trello to track tasks, and various data analysis tools to measure the performance of our marketing campaigns.

Question: Who helps you the most? And how?

Sample Answer: That would definitely be my direct manager. She has years of experience in the industry, and she's a great mentor. Whenever I'm facing a challenge, she provides clear guidance and constructive feedback that helps me to learn and improve. I've learned a huge amount from her.

Path B: Studies

Question: What subjects are you studying?

Sample Answer: I'm currently a final-year student majoring in English Linguistics at a university here in Dong Nai. My main subjects include things like phonetics, syntax, and sociolinguistics. It's quite a specialized field of study.

Question: Do you like your subject?

Sample Answer: Yes, I find it fascinating. I've always been interested in how language works, not just in speaking it, but in understanding its structure and how it evolves. Some of the theoretical concepts can be quite challenging, but overall, I really enjoy it.

Question: Why did you choose to study that subject?

Sample Answer: I've always had a passion for languages, and English in particular. Instead of just studying literature, I wanted to understand the science behind the language itself. I felt that studying

linguistics would give me a deeper, more analytical understanding that could be applied to many different careers.

Question: Do you think that your subject is popular in your country?

Sample Answer: Studying English is incredibly popular, but my specific major, Linguistics, is less so. Most students prefer to study English for teaching or translation, which are seen as more practical career paths. Linguistics is considered a bit more academic and niche.

Question: Do you have any plans for your studies in the next five years?

Sample Answer: Yes, after I graduate this year, I'm hoping to work for a year or two to gain some practical experience. After that, I'd really like to pursue a Master's degree, possibly abroad, to specialize further in an area like computational linguistics.

Question: What are the benefits of being your age?

Sample Answer: I think the main benefit is having a lot of energy and time to explore different possibilities. I'm old enough to be independent, but still young enough that I can afford to experiment with my career path and not have everything figured out yet. There's a lot of freedom in that.

Question: Do you want to change your major?

Sample Answer: No, not at all. While it can be difficult at times, I'm genuinely passionate about my major. I've invested a lot of time and effort into it, and I'm excited about the career prospects it could lead to. I'm happy with the choice I made.

Question: Do you prefer to study in the mornings or in the afternoons?

Sample Answer: I'm definitely a morning person when it comes to studying. I find that my mind is freshest and I can concentrate much better early in the day. By the afternoon, I start to feel a bit sluggish and find it harder to absorb new information effectively.

Question: How much time do you spend on your studies each week?

Sample Answer: It varies depending on whether I have exams or major assignments due. On an average week, I probably spend about 20 to 25 hours on my studies, including attending lectures and doing my own reading and research. It can get much more intense during exam periods.

Question: Are you looking forward to working?

Sample Answer: Yes, very much so. While I enjoy studying, I'm really excited to apply what I've learned in a real-world setting. I'm looking forward to having a proper routine, earning my own money, and gaining some financial independence. I feel ready for the next chapter.

Question: What technology do you use when you study?

Sample Answer: My laptop is my most essential tool. I use it for writing essays, accessing online journals and databases from the university library, and watching recorded lectures. I also use my phone a lot for quick look-ups and for using apps like Quizlet to revise vocabulary.

Question: What changes would you like to see in your school?

Sample Answer: I'd love to see more practical, career-oriented workshops. While the theoretical knowledge we gain is excellent, I think students would really benefit from more sessions on things like CV writing, interview skills, and networking with professionals in our field.

THE
FORUM

Topic 51: Social media

Question: What do people often do on social media?

Sample Answer: People do a whole range of things. Mainly, they share updates and photos about their own lives to stay connected with friends and family. Many also use it to follow news outlets or influencers to keep up with current events and trends. And of course, for a lot of people, it's a major source of entertainment – just scrolling through short videos and memes.

Question: Do your friends use social media?

Sample Answer: Yes, absolutely, every single one of them. It's probably our primary way of staying in touch on a daily basis. We have group chats where we make plans, we share interesting articles or funny videos with each other, and we see what everyone's up to. It's an integral part of how we socialize.

Question: Do you think you spend too much time on social media?

Sample Answer: Yes, I'd have to admit that I probably do. It's so easy to open an app just to check one thing, and then an hour later you find you've just been mindlessly scrolling. I sometimes look at my weekly screen time report and I'm genuinely surprised. It's definitely a habit I'm trying to be more mindful of.

Question: When did you start using social media?

Sample Answer: I think my first social media account was Facebook, and I created it when I was in high school, maybe around 13 or 14 years old. At the time, all of my friends were signing up, and it seemed like the exciting new way to communicate and share photos with each other outside of school.

Topic 52: Home & Accommodation

Question: Do you live in an apartment or a house?

Sample Answer: I live in a house with my family. It's a fairly typical multi-story terraced house, which is a very common type of housing for families in my city. It's not particularly large, but it's cozy and there's enough space for everyone to live comfortably.

Question: Who do you live with?

Sample Answer: I live with my parents and my younger brother. It's the cultural norm in Vietnam for unmarried children to continue living with their parents, so we all share the family home. It's quite nice, actually, as we are all very close and can support each other.

Question: Can you describe the place where you live?

Sample Answer: Sure. It's a three-story house in a quiet residential alley. The ground floor is an open-plan living and kitchen area where the family spends most of its time together. The bedrooms are on the upper two floors, which is good for privacy, and we have a small rooftop terrace where my mother grows some plants and herbs.

Question: What's your favorite room in your apartment or house?

Sample Answer: My favourite room is definitely my own bedroom. It's my personal sanctuary, the one place where I can completely relax, shut the door, and be myself. I've decorated it to my own taste, and it's filled with my books and things I love. It's my perfect space to unwind after a long day.

Question: How long have you lived there?

Sample Answer: I've lived in this house for pretty much my entire life. My parents had the house built when I was just a toddler, maybe two or three years old. So, all of my childhood memories are rooted in this home. I know every nook and cranny of it.

Question: Do you plan to live there for a long time?

Sample Answer: For the foreseeable future, yes. It's comfortable, convenient, and I enjoy living with my family. I imagine that eventually, when I get married and start my own family, I'll move out to find my own place. But for now, I'm very happy and have no immediate plans to leave.

Question: What kind of house or apartment do you want to live in in the future?

Sample Answer: My dream home would probably be a modern apartment in a high-rise building with great facilities, like a gym and a swimming pool. I'd love a place with big windows for lots of natural light, and a small balcony where I could enjoy a coffee and a nice city view.

THE
FORUM

Topic 53: Hometown

Question: Where is your hometown?

Sample Answer: My hometown is Bien Hoa city. It's the capital city of Dong Nai province, which is in the south of Vietnam. It's a well-known industrial hub and it's located right next to Ho Chi Minh City, so it's a very busy area.

Question: Is that a big city or a small place?

Sample Answer: It's definitely a big city. In fact, by population, it's one of the largest cities in Vietnam, although it's not as famous internationally as Hanoi or Ho Chi Minh City. Because it's a major industrial center, it has grown rapidly and is always bustling with activity.

Question: Please describe your hometown a little.

Sample Answer: Well, Bien Hoa is a very energetic and vibrant city. It's a real mix of old and new – you can see modern apartment buildings and shopping centers, but also find traditional markets and ancient pagodas. A lovely feature is the Dong Nai River that flows through the city, which provides some scenic and peaceful spots.

Question: How long have you been living there?

Sample Answer: I've been living here my entire life. I was born and raised in Bien Hoa, so I've witnessed its transformation from a smaller town into the major city it is today. I know the city like the back of my hand.

Question: What do you like (most) about your hometown?

Sample Answer: The thing I like most is probably the convenience and the food. Because it's a large city, everything you could possibly need is within easy reach. And the food scene is incredible; there's a huge variety of delicious and affordable street food on almost every corner.

Question: What's your hometown famous for?

Sample Answer: Historically, the region was famous for its traditional pottery villages. Nowadays, however, it's much more well-known as a major industrial hub. It's home to many large factories and industrial parks, which is why it has grown so much and attracts workers from all over the country.

Question: Have you learned anything about the history of your hometown?

Sample Answer: Yes, we learned a fair bit about it in school. We covered its development as a regional trading post and its strategic importance during the Vietnam War. It's not as historically famous as some other Vietnamese cities, but it definitely has its own rich past.

Question: Do you think you will continue living there for a long time?

Sample Answer: For the foreseeable future, yes. My current job and all of my family are here, so my roots are firmly planted for now. However, I'm always open to new experiences. If a fantastic career opportunity came up somewhere else, either in Vietnam or abroad, I would certainly consider making a move.

THE
FORUM

Topic 54: The area you live in

Question: Do you like the area that you live in?

Sample Answer: Yes, I really do. It offers a great balance. My house is on a fairly quiet residential street, so I don't get a lot of traffic noise, but it's also very conveniently located. There are plenty of shops, cafés, and a local market all within walking distance, so it feels like I get the best of both worlds.

Question: Do you live in a noisy or a quiet area?

Sample Answer: It's surprisingly quiet, actually. The main road about two streets away can be quite chaotic with traffic, but my house is tucked away in a small alley. This means my immediate neighborhood is shielded from most of that noise, so it's generally very peaceful, especially in the evenings.

Question: Do you know any of your neighbours?

Sample Answer: Yes, I know most of my immediate neighbours, at least by sight. It's a fairly close-knit community. We always say hello when we see each other outside, and sometimes we'll stop for a quick chat about things. It creates a very friendly and safe atmosphere in the neighbourhood.

Question: Where do you like to go in that area?

Sample Answer: There's a small local park nearby that I enjoy going to for an evening walk to get some fresh air. Other than that, my go-to spots are a couple of cozy coffee shops just around the corner. They have a really nice, relaxed atmosphere, and they're perfect for catching up with friends.

Question: What are some changes in the area recently?

Sample Answer: The most noticeable change in the last couple of years has been the number of new, trendy cafés and small restaurants that have opened up. It's made the area much more vibrant and popular with younger people. Also, a new high-rise apartment building was just completed nearby, which has brought a lot more residents to the area.

Question: Do you know any famous people in your area?

Sample Answer: No, not that I'm aware of. My city isn't really a major hub for celebrities like actors or singers; they tend to live in bigger media centers like Ho Chi Minh City. My neighbourhood is just a normal residential area, so as far as I know, we're all just regular people here.